

Help and Improvement

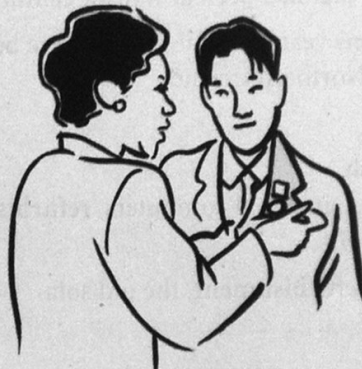
WORD LIST

abet	bestow	deliverance	expedite	haven
intercede	offset	pacify	refurbish	sanctuary

"No man is an island." This famous quotation implies that no one can operate without the help and support of others. The words in this lesson relate to ways that we can give and receive help, and improve the lives of ourselves and others.

1. **abet** (ə-bět') *verb* from Latin *ad-*, "to" + *beter*, "bait"
To encourage or assist, particularly in doing something wrong
 - A person who **abets** the criminal actions of another may also be found guilty of a crime.

abettor *noun* The **abettors** of terrorism will be caught and punished.



bestow

2. **bestow** (bĭ-stō') *verb* from Old English *bi-*, "be" + *stow*, "place"
To give or present, especially as a gift or an honor
 - The award was **bestowed** upon the artist for her lifetime achievements.

3. **deliverance** (dĭ-lĭv'ər-əns) *noun* from Latin *liberare*, "to free"
Liberation; rescue from slavery, capture, or danger
 - An 1841 shipwreck meant **deliverance** for Africans on a slave ship, who were freed when they swam ashore to British colonies.

Deliverance is taken from the verb *deliver*.

4. **expedite** (ĕk'spĭ-dīt') *verb* from Latin *expedire*, "to set free"
 - a. To speed up or help the progress of
 - Our business often uses express mail to **expedite** delivery of packages.
 - b. To do quickly and efficiently
 - The company president trusted her assistant to **expedite** her orders.

expeditious *adjective* During the fire drill, the students filed out of the building in an **expeditious** manner.

5. **haven** (hā'vən) *noun*
A place of refuge or safety
 - During unstable political times, embassies are often **havens** for travelers stranded in foreign countries.

A *haven* can also be a port or harbor.

6. **intercede** (in 'tär-sēd') *verb* from Latin *inter-*, "between" + *cedere*, "to go"

a. To mediate or help in a problem between others

- The referee **interceded** when the two coaches started shouting at each other.

b. To plead for another

- The relief agency **interceded** on behalf of refugees, calling for additional aid.

intercession *noun* When the nurse was falsely accused of stealing, the doctor's **intercession** helped prevent the loss of her job.

7. **offset** (ôf 'sēt') *verb*

To make up for; to compensate for; to counteract

- The runner **offset** her slow time in the first lap, by speeding up her pace in the next two.

8. **pacify** (päs 'ə-fī') *verb* from Latin *pax*, "peace" + *facere*, "to make"

a. To calm anger

- When the singer failed to appear at the concert, the management issued refunds to **pacify** the crowd.

b. To establish peace; to end fighting or violence

- The treaty **pacified** regions that had been at war for centuries.

pacification *noun* In the last few years, several nations have been involved in the **pacification** of Northern Ireland.

9. **refurbish** (rē-fūr 'bīsh) *verb*

To clean, renew, repair, or refresh

- Anthony made a business of buying used computers, **refurbishing** them, then selling them for profit.

refurbishment *noun* After its **refurbishment**, the old sofa looked new.

10. **sanctuary** (sängk 'chōō-ēr'ē) *noun* from Latin *sanctus*, "sacred"

a. Any place of safety or protection

- The animals roamed freely in the wildlife **sanctuary**.

b. A holy place; a house of worship

- The organ was playing as we entered the **sanctuary** to pray.

Offset can also be used as a noun, as in "The refund was an *offset* for her overpayment."

WORD ENRICHMENT

Words of peace

The word *pacific* comes from the Latin word *pax*, meaning "peace." Other English words come from this root, including *peace* itself. A *pact*, or "agreement," also comes from *pax*, as does *appease*, which means to calm, usually by giving into demands.

The name of one of the world's great oceans comes from *pax*. In 1513, Spanish explorer Vasco Nunez de Balboa crossed the Isthmus of Panama and saw an ocean. So peaceful did it appear, he named it the *Pacific*.

RITE THE CORRECT WORD

Write the correct word in the space next to each definition.

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| _____ 1. to make peace | _____ 6. to mediate |
| _____ 2. to speed up the progress of | _____ 7. to clean up or repair |
| _____ 3. rescue from danger | _____ 8. a refuge |
| _____ 4. a place of worship | _____ 9. to counteract |
| _____ 5. to encourage | _____ 10. to present an honor |

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

Write the letter for the word that best completes each sentence.

- _____ 1. You should probably _____ your rusty bike before you try to sell it.
a. refurbish b. offset c. bestow d. expedite
- _____ 2. In earlier times, criminals could avoid arrest by seeking _____ in churches.
a. expedition b. sanctuary c. pacification d. refurbishment
- _____ 3. She _____ the criminal by allowing him to stay in her home.
a. offset b. refurbished c. bestowed d. abetted
- _____ 4. The queen can reward loyal subjects by _____ honorary titles.
a. expediting b. abetting c. offsetting d. bestowing
- _____ 5. The ambassador tried to _____ on behalf of the falsely accused travelers.
a. expedite b. refurbish c. intercede d. bestow
- _____ 6. In winter, a backyard feeder can become a(n) _____ for birds.
a. haven b. refurbishment c. pacification d. intercession
- _____ 7. Before the U.S. Civil War, the Underground Railroad provided _____ for escaped slaves seeking freedom.
a. pacification b. deliverance c. bestowment d. refurbishment
- _____ 8. The efficient computer system helped the company to _____ their orders.
a. pacify b. expedite c. refurbish d. offset
- _____ 9. Nothing but an appearance by their leader could _____ the angry crowd.
a. expedite b. abet c. pacify d. bestow
- _____ 10. The penalties received by the two teams _____ one another, so the play had to be repeated.
a. pacified b. bestowed c. interceded d. offset

Challenge: In order to _____ the unhappy residents, the director _____ the refurbishment of the recreation room.

- a. abet...offset b. bestow...pacified c. pacify...expedited

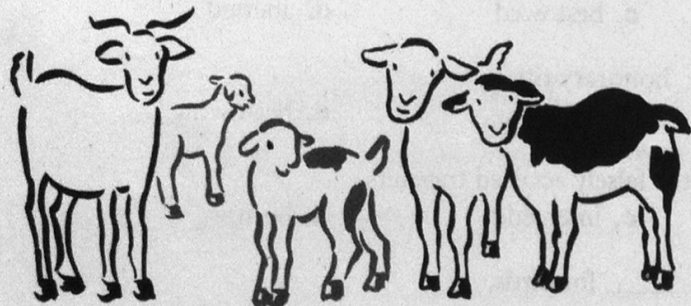
READING COMPREHENSION

"They Need a Cow"

"These children don't need a cup, they need a cow," thought Dan West.

West was frustrated that his volunteer efforts during the Spanish Civil War of the 1930s did not seem to be helping enough people. Day after day, hungry children begged for the food that he distributed, but the provisions that he gave to one, he had to deny to another. (1) West decided that simply *bestowing* food would not improve lives. (2) People needed a way to *refurbish* their own food supplies. Thus, Operation Heifer, now Heifer International, was born.

Heifer International gives livestock—heifers (young cows), goats, and even bees—to people in need. These animals provide renewable sources of food, such as milk and honey. (3) However, giving one family a goat, while ignoring another family, would *abet* inequality. So any family that receives livestock is required to give the animal's first born offspring to another needy family. (4) Or the family can keep the offspring and *offset* the livestock gift by giving another family enough money to buy its own animal.



Early missions of Heifer International brought cowhands to war-torn Europe, in the 1940s. (5) In countries like Poland, the organization provided *deliverance* from poverty, as farmers once again were

able to produce their own food. (6) At first, animals and volunteers traveled by ship, but the process was *expedited* when they began to travel by plane. In an account of his journey to Korea, cowboy Newton S. Goodridge paints a vivid picture of traveling on a plane with 100 goats, 600 rabbits, and an estimated 1,500,000 bees! Heifer International has helped more than 4.5 million farm families in over a hundred countries to become self-reliant.

A terrible civil war in Mozambique pushed hundreds of thousands of people from their lands. (7) These refugees were forced to seek *sanctuary* in neighboring countries. (8) Seventeen years after the war began, a treaty *pacified* the country. (9) When people returned from their *havens*, they had no livestock and found that years of violence had turned their once-fertile land to dust. (10) In 1995, Heifer International *interceded* by supplying goats to families. By 1999, more than 1,600 baby goats had been given to others.

Some aid recipients have achieved such success for themselves that they have been able to increase the required livestock gift. In 2001, Ganga Devi Khanai received two goats from Heifer International. Within a year, she had enough money to pay for her children's schooling and to buy a water buffalo. That animal helped her to farm and provided milk for her to sell. Ganga was required to pass on two goats to others, but in gratitude, she decided to give a third goat. Ganga also helped to found a cooperative business that funds community schooling for women.

The mooing of cows, the bleating of goats, and the buzzing of bees are all signs that Heifer International is on the way. Its volunteers spread dignity and hope to people worldwide.

Each sentence below refers to a numbered sentence in the passage. Write the letter of the choice that gives the sentence a meaning that is closest to the original sentence.

- _____ 1. West decided that simply _____ food would not improve lives.
a. removing b. giving c. producing d. rescuing
- _____ 2. People needed a way to _____ their own food supplies.
a. renew b. speed up c. store d. consume
- _____ 3. Giving one family a goat, while ignoring another, would _____ inequality.
a. encourage b. eliminate c. rescue d. argue for
- _____ 4. Or the family can keep the offspring and _____ the livestock gift.
a. encourage b. repair c. plead for d. make up for

- _____ 5. In countries like Poland, the organization provided _____ from poverty.
 a. refreshment b. honor c. escape d. peace
- _____ 6. The process was _____ when they began to travel by plane.
 a. repaired b. calmed down c. presented d. sped up
- _____ 7. These refugees were forced to seek _____ in neighboring countries.
 a. progress b. honors c. safety d. food
- _____ 8. Seventeen years after the war began, a treaty _____ the country.
 a. helped to assist b. ended fighting in c. caused hunger in d. frightened
- _____ 9. When people returned from their _____, they had no livestock.
 a. protected areas b. places of worship c. former slavery d. retirement homes
- _____ 10. In 1995, Heifer International _____ by supplying goats to families.
 a. caused trouble b. provided help c. got in the way d. made peace

Indicate whether the statements below are TRUE or FALSE according to the passage.

- _____ 1. A goal of Heifer International is to help families become self-reliant.
- _____ 2. Heifer International limits its activities to a few countries in Europe.
- _____ 3. Aid recipients are required to donate to another needy family.

FINISH THE THOUGHT

Complete each sentence so that it shows the meaning of the italicized word.

1. One way to *pacify* a baby is to _____

2. Someone has *interceded* for me when _____

WRITE THE DERIVATIVE

Complete the sentence by writing the correct form of the word shown in parentheses. You may not need to change the form that is given.

- _____ 1. The money Joe earns working in the convenience store more than _____ his increasing school-activity costs. (*offset*)
- _____ 2. Most people seek _____ from misfortune at some point in their lives. (*deliverance*)

- _____ 3. The school principal _____ strong praise on the winners of the achievement awards. (*bestow*)
- _____ 4. In the Old West, _____ a cattle rustler could get you in a heap of trouble. (*abet*)
- _____ 5. Holding a fair election restored calm and _____ the uprising. (*pacify*)
- _____ 6. As the gale force winds grew stronger, the ship's captain searched his charts of the Maine seacoast for a _____ where he could ride out the storm. (*haven*)
- _____ 7. Were it not for their friend's _____, the quarrel between the brothers might have turned violent. (*intercede*)
- _____ 8. The speedy courier delivered the letter in a manner that can only be described as _____. (*expedite*)
- _____ 9. Because of the loss of their natural habitat, many birds and animals are forced to live in wildlife _____. (*sanctuary*)
- _____ 10. _____ old appliances can conserve resources. (*refurbish*)

FIND THE EXAMPLE

Choose the answer that best describes the action or situation.

- _____ 1. Something from which people need *deliverance*
 a. good fortune b. rescuers c. fine weather d. kidnapping
- _____ 2. Something you might *refurbish*
 a. a school report b. a barrel of trash c. a new house d. an old house
- _____ 3. Something in need of *pacification*
 a. an angry mob b. a peaceful protest c. a quiet courtroom d. a religious service
- _____ 4. Something that might *expedite* a carpenter's work
 a. a heavy rain b. noisy onlookers c. power tools d. a tax audit
- _____ 5. An example of a *haven*
 a. an open field b. a warm shelter c. a cold prison d. a cool breeze
- _____ 6. Something in which you might *intercede*
 a. a dance b. a disagreement c. a speech d. a party
- _____ 7. Something that could provide *sanctuary* to birds
 a. a birdhouse b. bird food c. a bird song d. a bird book
- _____ 8. One way to *abet*
 a. gambling b. discouraging c. giving information d. reading
- _____ 9. Things that *offset* each other
 a. cooking and singing b. brother and sister c. wind and rain d. savings and expenses
- _____ 10. Something that could be *bestowed*
 a. a knighthood b. a driver's license c. a water bottle d. a sandwich